HOST ADMINISTRATION GUIDE

Plas Hafod & Bryn Bugeiliaid Bach

Standard Operating Procedures: Booking Workflow, Seasonal Pricing, BACS Banking & Deposits

Studio Login: `https://plashafodcottage.co.uk/studio`

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Effective Date: November 2026 onwards

🔑 Accessing Sanity Studio

Open your browser on any computer, tablet, or phone and navigate to **`https://plashafodcottage.co.uk/studio`**.

Log in with your host Google or Sanity credentials. Everything you need to manage your business is in the left sidebar.

✦ Sanity Studio Navigation Map

Here is how your Studio sidebar is organised and where each host function lives:

📁 Booking Engine

- **Cottages ➔ Plas Hafod:**
  - `Rates:` Set base rate, fixed/percentage deposit, pet fees, cleaning & seasonal rate overrides.
  - `Bookings:` Inbox of all Plas Hafod reservation requests.
  - `Blocked Dates:` Block dates for owner stays or maintenance.
- **Cottages ➔ Bryn Bugeiliaid Bach:**
  - `Rates:` Annexe base rate, deposit options, cleaning & seasonal rates.
  - `Bookings:` Annexe reservation inbox.
- **All Bookings:** Master calendar & unified inbox.
- **Seasons:** Central calendar directory of seasonal dates.
- **Special offers / discounts:** Weekly & promo discounts.

⚙️ Site Settings & Global Config

- **Bank Transfer Details (BACS):**
  Update Account Name, Bank Name, Sort Code, Account Number, and custom payment instructions.
- **Email Copy & Notification Settings:**
  Global default deposit mode, host alert email recipients, and default booking confirmation text.
- **General Business Details:**
  Emergency host contact numbers, check-in times (4:00 PM), and check-out times (10:00 AM).

✅ Two Golden Rules for Sanity Studio

1. **Always Publish:** When editing Rates, Seasons, or Site Settings, always click the green **Publish** button at the bottom right.
2. **Instant Dispatch:** Interactive buttons in the booking inbox (e.g. *Send Deposit Request*, *Mark Paid*) update the database and dispatch emails immediately.

1 Managing the Booking Process & Workflow

When a guest submits a booking inquiry online, the system alerts you via email and places a new inquiry in your Studio inbox. The workflow has 3 simple stages:



STAGE 1 Review Inquiry & Send Deposit Request

Path: `Booking Engine → Cottages → Bookings`

1. Click the guest's booking. The top card shows the **Deposit Request & BACS Payment Dispatcher**.
2. Check the dates, nights, quote breakdown, and auto-generated payment reference (e.g. `PH-2612-MORRIS`).
3. *Optional:* Type a message into **Personal Host Message** (e.g. welcoming them to Snowdonia).
4. Click `✉ Re-send / Send Deposit Request Email`.

What happens: Status updates to **DEPOSIT REQUESTED**. A combined reservation acknowledgment and deposit payment request email is sent immediately with your bank details and payment reference. The dates are held on the website calendar.

STAGE 2 Confirm Deposit Cleared in Your Bank Account

Bank Reconciliation

1. Log into your Lloyds Bank app or online banking and check that the deposit has arrived with the matching reference.
2. Open the booking in Sanity Studio.
3. Click `Mark Deposit Cleared & Confirmed ✓`.

What happens: Status badge changes to **CONFIRMED BOOKING - AWAITING FULL PAYMENT**. A confirmation receipt is automatically dispatched to the guest confirming their dates are secured and stating the balance due date.

STAGE 3 Mark Paid & Immediate Directions Dispatch

Final Settlement

1. When the guest transfers the remaining balance into your bank account:
2. Open the booking in Sanity Studio.
3. Click `Mark Paid & Confirmed ✓`.

What happens: Status becomes **COMPLETE AND CONFIRMED (PAID IN FULL)**. The guest **immediately** receives their full payment receipt and complete **Directions & Check-in Instructions** (including cottage-specific directions and key safe code). No timer or delay needed!

❌ Declining or Cancelling a Booking

If you cannot accommodate an inquiry (or a guest cancels), change the **Status** dropdown to **Declined / Cancelled**. This automatically releases the held dates back to the public booking calendar.

2 Setting Seasons & Nightly Rates

Plas Hafod uses a clean 2-tier pricing model: **Seasons** define shared calendar date spans, and **Cottage Rates** specify the price, deposit mode, and minimum stay for each cottage.

Part A: The Central Seasons Directory

Navigate to: `Booking Engine ➔ Seasons`. Here you manage dates that apply to both cottages:

- Click **Create Season (+)** at the top to add a new holiday period.
- Enter **Season Name** (e.g. `February Half Term 2027 (Welsh Schools)`).
- Select **Start Date** and **End Date** from the calendar popup.
- Set **Default Minimum Stay** (e.g. 2 or 3 nights) and click **Publish**.

> 💡 **Smart Priority: Broad Seasons vs. School Half Terms**
>
> The pricing engine automatically prioritises shorter, specific date windows (e.g. 10-day or 17-day school half terms) over broad multi-month blocks (like Winter or Autumn). You never have to split your broad winter season—just define the general Winter season, and add the school half terms over it; the system automatically charges the half-term rate on those specific dates!

Part B: Setting Cottage Rates, Deposits & Pet Fees

Navigate to: `Booking Engine ➔ Cottages ➔ Plas Hafod (or Bryn Bugeiliaid Bach) ➔ Rates`.

Standard Base Rate (£):	Default nightly price when no season applies (£175 for PH, £145 for BBB).
Deposit Calculation Mode:	Choose **Fixed Amount (£)** or **Percentage of Total (%)** directly on each cottage.
Fixed Deposit Amount (£):	Set the flat deposit in GBP (default: £200).
Required Deposit Percentage (%):	Set percentage of stay when in Percentage mode (default: 25%).
Pet Fee — 1 Dog (£):	Surcharge for 1 dog at Plas Hafod (Set to **£40**).
Pet Fee — 2 Dogs (£):	Total surcharge for 2 dogs at Plas Hafod (Set to **£55**). *Annexe is pet-free.*
Seasonal Rates & Peak Periods:	Click **Add item**, pick a Season from the dropdown, and set this cottage's nightly rate and minimum stay.

Current Seasonal Tariffs (2026 / 2027)

Season Name	Date Span	Plas Hafod	Bryn Bugeiliaid Bach	Min Stay
Winter Season 2026	01/11/2026 → 19/12/2026	**£165 / night**	**£135 / night**	2 nights
Festive Season (Christmas / New Year)	20/12/2026 → 05/01/2027	**£285 / night**	**£225 / night**	4 nts (PH) / 3 (BBB)
Winter Season 2027	06/01/2027 → 25/03/2027	**£165 / night**	**£135 / night**	2 nights
Feb Half Term (Welsh Schools)	12/02/2027 → 21/02/2027	**£195 / night**	**£160 / night**	3 nts (PH) / 2 (BBB)
Feb Half Term (English Schools)	12/02/2027 → 28/02/2027	**£195 / night**	**£160 / night**	3 nts (PH) / 2 (BBB)
Whitsun / May Half Term 2027	21/05/2027 → 06/06/2027	**£225 / night**	**£185 / night**	3 nights
Summer Peak 2026	01/06/2026 → 31/08/2026	**£245 / night**	**£195 / night**	3 nights

3 Managing Special Offers & Discounts

Special offers allow you to encourage longer bookings (e.g. weekly discounts) or run seasonal promotions.
Navigate to: `Booking Engine ➔ Special offers / discounts`.

➕ Creating or Editing a Special Offer

Click **Create Special Offer (+)** to add a new promotion, or select an existing one to edit its details:

Offer Title:	Customer-facing name (e.g. `Full Week Retreat (7+ Nights)` or `Midweek Winter Warmer`).
Applicable Cottage:	Choose **Both Cottages**, **Plas Hafod Cottage**, or **Bryn Bugeiliaid Bach**.
Discount Type:	Select **Percentage Off (%)** or **Fixed Amount (£)**.
Discount Value:	Enter the number (e.g. `12` for 12% off, or `50` for a £50 discount).
Trigger: Minimum Nights:	How many nights the guest must book for this discount to trigger (e.g. 7 nights).
Promo Code (Optional):	Leave blank for automatic checkout discount, or specify a code (e.g. `RETREAT26`) for private offers.
Valid From / Valid Until:	Optional date range for limited-time promotions.
Active Offer (Checkbox):	Toggle off to temporarily pause an offer without deleting it.

Example Promotion Scenarios

Scenario	Discount Type	Value	Min Nights	Property
Full Week Stay Discount	Percentage Off (%)	**12%**	7 nights	Both Cottages
Fortnight Extended Stay	Percentage Off (%)	**20%**	14 nights	Both Cottages
Winter Midweek Special	Fixed Amount (£)	**£40 off**	3 nights	Plas Hafod
Private Return Guest Voucher	Percentage Off (%)	**10%** (Code: `WELCOMEBACK`)	2 nights	Both Cottages

💡 How Guests See Discounts

When a guest selects dates on the website booking form matching the minimum night requirement, the discount is calculated in real time and displayed as an itemised deduction in the price breakdown before they book.

4 Updating Bank Details (BACS Transfer)

Navigate to: `Site Settings ➔ Scroll to "Bank Transfer Details (BACS)"`. Any change made here immediately synchronises with the website, your host dispatcher, and all guest emails.

Bank / Institution Name:	e.g. `Lloyds Bank`, `Barclays`, `HSBC`
Account Holder Name:	e.g. `SIWSAN BRODA - Plas Hafod` (exact payee name shown to guests)
Sort Code:	6 digits with hyphens: `77-48-24`
Account Number:	8-digit UK account number: `15999760`
IBAN & BIC (Optional):	Available for international transfers.
Deposit Instructions (EN/CY):	Instructions advising guests to quote their reference number.

5 Changing Deposit Options (Fixed vs. Percentage)

You can change the deposit calculation mode either on the specific cottage's **Rates document** (`Booking Engine ➔ Cottages ➔ Rates`) or globally in `Site Settings` :

Calculation Mode	Formula	How to Change & What to Set
Fixed Amount (£) (Current Default)	Flat £200 fee regardless of total stay price.	Select **Fixed Amount (£)** radio, then enter the desired sum in the **Fixed Deposit Amount (£)** field (e.g. `200`).
Percentage of Total (%)	Calculates 25% of the total booking cost.	Select **Percentage of Total (%)** radio, then set the percentage in **Required Deposit Percentage (%)** (e.g. 25).

6 Host Quick Reference Cheat-Sheet

Action Required	Where to Go in Studio	Button or Field
Send Deposit Request to Guest	`Booking Engine ➔ Cottages ➔ Bookings`	Click `Send Deposit Request Email`
Confirm Deposit Arrived in Bank	Inside the Booking Inquiry document	Click `Mark Deposit Cleared & Confirmed ✓`
Full Payment Received & Send Directions	Inside the Booking Inquiry document	Click `Mark Paid & Confirmed ✓`
Change Deposit Option (Fixed vs. %)	`Booking Engine ➔ Cottages ➔ Rates`	Select `Deposit Calculation Mode` radio & **Publish**
Change Base Rates or Dog Fees	`Booking Engine ➔ Cottages ➔ Rates`	Edit `Base Rate`, `Pet Fee`, or `Seasonal Rates`
Add a New School Holiday Season	`Booking Engine ➔ Seasons`	Click **Create Season (+)** & enter start/end dates
Update Bank Account / Sort Code	`Site Settings ➔ Bank Transfer Details`	Edit fields & click **Publish**